

Section A contains four composition briefs from which students will select one as the basis for a three-minute composition. Section B will contain the opening bars of four pieces of music. Students will complete these openings in a specified style. Both sections of the examination must be completed under controlled conditions. The composition and technical study will be externally assessed.

- Externally assessed
- Availability: June

**40%
of the
total A2
marks****20% of
the total
GCE
marks****Content summary:**

This unit focuses on listening to music, familiar and unfamiliar, and understanding how it works.

Set works from the anthology provide the focus for much of the unit. It is recommended that students familiarise themselves with each work as a whole, before concentrating on important musical features, context and/or elements of continuity and change. Between works students should also listen to a wide range of unfamiliar music which relates to the two compulsory areas of study. They should learn how to compare and contrast pairs of excerpts, contextualise music and identify harmonic and tonal features.

Assessment:

Assessment is through a 2 hour examination paper set and marked by Edexcel.

There are three sections: Section A: Aural analysis, Section B: Music in context and Section C: Continuity and change in instrumental music. Section A requires students to listen to extract of music and one CD per examination centre will be provided by Edexcel. A skeleton score is provided for Section A.

Students are given five minutes' reading time at the start of the examination.

Each student must have access to an unmarked copy of the anthology during the examination.

* See *Appendix 3* for description of this code and all other codes relevant to this qualification.

B Specification overview

Summary of unit content

Unit number and unit title	Level	Summary of unit content
Unit 1: Performing Music	AS	This unit gives students the opportunities to perform as soloists and/or as part of an ensemble. Teachers and students can choose music in any style. Any instrument(s) and/or voice(s) are acceptable as part of a five-six minute assessed performance. Notated and/or improvised performances may be submitted.
Unit 2: Composing	AS	This unit encourages students to develop their composition skills leading to the creation of a three-minute piece in response to a chosen brief. Students also write a CD sleeve note to describe aspects of their final composition and explain how other pieces of music have influenced it.
Unit 3: Developing Musical Understanding	AS	This unit focuses on listening to familiar music and understanding how it works Set works from the anthology provide the focus for the first two sections, through listening and studying scores. It is recommended that students familiarise themselves with each work as a whole, before learning how to identify important musical features and their social and historical context. In the third section, students use a score to identify harmonic and tonal features, and then apply this knowledge in the completion of a short and simple passage for SATB.
Unit 4: Extended Performance	A2	This unit gives students the opportunities to extend their performance skills as soloists and/or as part of an ensemble. Teachers and students can choose music in any style. Any instrument(s) and/or voice(s) are acceptable as part of a 12-15 minute assessed performance of a balanced programme of music. Notated and/or improvised performances may be submitted.
Unit 5: Composition and Technical Study	A2	This unit has two sections: composition and technical study. The composition section further develops students' composition skills, leading to the creation of a final three-minute piece in response to a chosen brief. The technical study section builds on the knowledge and awareness of harmony gained in Unit 3 section C through the medium of pastiche studies. Students must complete two tasks in this unit choosing from either one composition and one technical study or two compositions or two technical studies.
Unit 6: Further Musical Understanding	A2	This unit focuses on listening to music, familiar and unfamiliar, and understanding how it works. Set works from the anthology, using different selections from those in Unit 3 — provide the focus for much of the unit. It is recommended that students familiarise themselves with each work as a whole, before concentrating on important musical features, context and/or elements of continuity and change. Students should also listen to a wide range of unfamiliar music related to the two compulsory areas of study. They should learn how to compare and contrast pairs of excerpts, contextualise music and identify harmonic and tonal features.

Summary of assessment requirements

Unit number and unit title	Level	Assessment information	Number of marks allocated in the unit
Unit 1: Performing Music	AS	The music performed (one or more pieces) is chosen and assessed by the centre and moderated by Edexcel. Each student can perform as soloists and/or as part of an ensemble. Teachers and students can choose music in any style. Any instrument(s) and/or voice(s) are acceptable as part of a 5-6 minute performance. Notated and/or improvised performances may be submitted. Performances may be recorded and rerecorded at any time during the course.	40
Unit 2: Composing	AS	In September of each year Edexcel will publish on its website (www.edexcel.com) a document entitled <i>Unit 2: Composing</i>. Section A will contain four composition briefs from which candidates will select one as the basis for a three-minute composition. The composition may be for any instrument or voice or combination of instruments and/or voices and in any style, this will be subject to the requirements of the composition brief selected. The composition must be presented as a score* and as a recording. *The word 'score' refers to any of the following: a full score in conventional staff notation; a lead sheet or chord chart; track sheets; tables or diagrams. Two briefs will be derived from topics related to the area of study Instrumental Music and two from topics related to the area of study Vocal Music. In Section B students will answer three questions to provide information that could be used for a CD sleeve note to accompany their composition. Both sections of the examination must be completed under controlled conditions.	60
Unit 3: Developing Musical Understanding	AS	Assessment is through a 2 hour examination paper set and marked by Edexcel. There are three sections: Section A: Listening; Section B: Investigating musical styles, and Section C: Understanding chords and lines. Section A requires students to listen to extracts of music: and one CD per examination centre will be provided by Edexcel. In Section C, students may use a keyboard with headphones. A skeleton score is provided for Section A. Candidates are given five minutes' reading time at the start of the examination. Candidates will not have access to copy of the anthology during the examination nor to any musical software for Section C.	80

Unit number and unit title	Level	Assessment information	Number of marks allocated in the unit
Unit 4: Extended Performance	A2	The music performed (one or more pieces) is chosen and assessed by the centre and moderated by Edexcel. Each candidate can perform as a soloist and/or as part of an ensemble. Teachers and students can choose music in any style. Any instrument(s) and/or voice(s) are acceptable as part of a 12-15 minute performance of a balanced programme of music. Notated and/or improvised performances may be submitted. The 12-15 minute performance will be assessed by the teacher and Performances may be recorded and rerecorded at any time during the course. The music must be performed to the teacher and at least one other person. A larger audience may be present at the student's discretion.	50
Unit 5: Composition and Technical Study	A2	In September of each year Edexcel will publish on its website the <i>Unit 5: Section A – Composition. Section B – Technical Study</i> will be posted to you for release on 1st April and will include a hard copy of the composition briefs. Section A contains four composition briefs from which candidates will select one or more as the basis of a three-minute composition. The piece may be for any instrument or voice or combination of instruments and/or voices and in any style, this will be subject to the requirements of the composition brief selected. Two briefs will be derived from topics for the area of study Instrumental music and two briefs will be derived from topics for the area of study Applied music Section B will contain three technical study topics from which students choose one. The topics remain constant during the life of the specification, but the composition briefs and technical study opening based on them will change each year. Both sections of the examination must be completed under controlled conditions. The composition and technical study will be externally assessed.	80
Unit 6: Further Musical Understanding	A2	Assessment is through a 2-hour examination paper set and marked by Edexcel. There are three sections: ■ Section A: Aural analysis ■ Section B: Music in context ■ Section C: Continuity and change in instrumental music. Section A requires students to listen to an extract of music and one CD per examination centre will be provided by Edexcel. A skeleton score is provided for Section A. Candidates are given five minutes' reading time at the start of the examination. Each candidate must have access to an unmarked copy of the anthology during the examination.	90

Assessment objectives and weightings

		% in AS	% in A2	% in GCE
AO1	Interpret musical ideas with technical and expressive control and a sense of style and awareness of occasion and/or ensemble (performing/realising)	30%	30%	30%
AO2	Create and develop musical ideas with technical control and expressive understanding making use of musical devices, conventions and resources (composing/arranging)	30%	30%	30%
AO3	Demonstrate understanding of and comment perceptively on, the structural, expressive and contextual aspects of music (appraising).	40%	40%	40%
TOTAL		100%	100%	100%

Relationship of assessment objectives to units

Unit number	Assessment objective			
	AO1	AO2	AO3	Total for AO1, AO2 and AO3
Unit 1	15%	0%	0%	15%
Unit 2	0%	10%	5%	15%
Unit 3	0%	5%	15%	20%
Unit 4	15%	0%	0%	15%
Unit 5	0%	15%	0%	15%
Unit 6	0%	0%	20%	20%
Total for Advanced GCE	30%	30%	40%	100%

Qualification summary

Subject criteria

The General Certificate of Education is part of the Level 3 provision. This specification is based on the Advanced Subsidiary GCE and Advanced Level GCE subject criteria for music; which are prescribed by the regulatory authorities and are mandatory for all awarding bodies.

The Advanced GCE in Music has been designed to enable students to experience a wide range of musical skills including performing, composing and analysing, as well as developing an understanding of the historical and contextual uses of music.

Aims

The aims of the Edexcel Advanced Subsidiary GCE and Advanced Level GCE in Music are to enable students to:

- extend the skills, knowledge and understanding needed to communicate through music and take part in music making
- engage in, and extend the appreciation of the diverse and dynamic heritage of music, promoting spiritual and cultural development
- develop particular strengths and interests encouraging life-long learning and providing access to music-related and other careers
- recognise the interdependence of musical skills, knowledge and understanding and the links between the activities of performing/realising, composing and appraising.

AS/A2 knowledge and understanding

This Advanced Subsidiary GCE and Advanced Level GCE specification enables students to gain an experience of a wide range of musical skills including performing, composing and analysing as well as developing an understanding of the historical and contextual uses of music. Students will develop:

- analytical skills
- knowledge and understanding of performance
- knowledge and understanding of compositional processes.

AS/A2 skills

For this Advanced Subsidiary GCE and Advanced Level GCE specification students need to develop practical skills in music-making activities, including:

- performing (eg solo, ensemble, improvising)
- composing (free composition, technical study)
- aural analysis skills.

C Music unit content

Unit 1 Performing Music	19
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Unit 2 Composing	39
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Unit 3 Developing Musical Understanding	57
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Unit 4 Extended Performance	63
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Unit 5 Composition and Technical Study	85
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Unit 6 Further Musical Understanding	111
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Course structure

- Edexcel's Advanced GCE in Music comprises six units and contains an Advanced Subsidiary subset of three AS units.
- The Advanced Subsidiary GCE is the first half of the GCE course and consists of Units 1, 2 and 3. It may be awarded as a discrete qualification or contribute 50 per cent of the total Advanced GCE marks.
- The full Advanced GCE award consists of the three AS units (Units 1, 2 and 3), plus three A2 units (Units 4, 5 and 6) which make up the other 50% of the Advanced GCE. Students wishing to take the full Advanced Level GCE must, therefore, complete all six units.
- The structure of this qualification allows teachers to construct a course of study which can be taught and assessed either as:
 - ◆ distinct modules of teaching and learning with related units of assessment taken at appropriate stages during the course; or
 - ◆ a linear course which is assessed in its entirety at the end.

Areas of study (AoS)

Areas of study are fundamental to the specification. Each area provides opportunities not only for the study of repertoire but also for the development of musical ideas through composing and performing activities. The specification encourages integration of the various musical disciplines throughout.

There are three areas of study:

- AoS1 Instrumental music
- AoS2 Vocal music
- AoS3 Applied music.

At Advanced Subsidiary Level students study Instrumental music and Vocal music.

AoS1 Instrumental music

This area of study, which belongs to both AS and A2, is designed to embrace a wide number of instrumental styles and traditions, including full-scale orchestral works and chamber music. Everything is from the western classical tradition.

AoS2 Vocal music

This area of study is designed to help students understand and appreciate the important role, in various places and at various times, of music for voices only or for voices and instruments.

AoS3 Applied music

The works in AoS1 and AoS2 are largely 'pure' music for concert or domestic performance, whereas those selected here are 'applied' to a range of other situations with music serving some wider purpose. For example, some pieces are used in dance, while others are for ritual (including worship) or to accompany the moving image in film or television.

At A2 students continue to study Instrumental music and also study Applied music.

For each area of study there are set works. These are published in the *New Anthology of Music*, editor J. Winterson (Peters, 2000).

Set works change from year to year. Please refer to *Unit 3: Developing Musical Understanding* for the AS set works (2009–2013) and *Unit 6: Further Musical Understanding* for set works at A2 (2010–2014). The lists of set works have been carefully selected to provide historical and stylistic variety and consistency and equality at each level across the lifetime of the specification. Thus each list within each area of study contains a broadly equal amount of music in terms of demand and duration. The wide range of set works within each area will allow students to make chronological and stylistic comparisons.